Forms

Abi Harrison-Nye

What is it for?

An accessible form is an online form that everyone can fill in, including people with vision, movement, or cognitive disabilities. Inaccessible forms create significant barriers, including:

- Missing or unlinked labels
- Poor keyboard navigation
- Vague error messages
- Small tap targets
- Overly complex layouts or time limits

How to support it

- Always use `<label>` tags and associate them with their inputs
- Use a `<fieldset>` to group related items and a `<legend>` to describe the group
- Provide clear error validation that identifies the field, describes the problem, and suggests a correction
- Ensure every form field, link, and button can be reached using only the keyboard, in a logical sequence
- Use high-contrast colours, and ensure all clickable elements have a large enough target size

Useful Links

W3C WAI: Forms Tutorial

WebAIM: Creating Accessible Forms

MDN: Web Forms